PRACTICE EXAM 20 / EXAM SET 03

Domain 6: Communication and Customer Service

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Patient-Centered Communication

> **SCENARIO** During intake, a patient says, "I have been feeling funny lately." The medical assistant has not yet learned what the patient means by "funny." The patient is seated comfortably and is able to continue the conversation.

Which question best clarifies the patient's meaning without suggesting an answer?

A. "Would you describe the feeling as dizziness rather than nervousness?"

B. "What do you mean when you say you have been feeling funny?"

C. "Does feeling funny usually happen after you take your morning medicine?"

D. "Would you say this is the same feeling you had at your previous visit?"

Q02 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

> **SCENARIO** A scheduled interpreter connects for an intake interview. Before clinical questions begin, the patient indicates that they cannot understand the interpreter's regional language variety. The interpreter also reports difficulty understanding the patient. Clinic policy requires staff to stop substantive questioning when interpretation is ineffective and contact the language-service coordinator for an appropriate qualified interpreter.

Which action best addresses this mismatch?

A. Ask the interpreter to continue using shorter sentences and accept nods as confirmation.

B. Switch the interview to written questions in the same language without checking reading ability.

C. Ask the interpreter to infer unfamiliar expressions from the patient's gestures and context.

D. Pause the interview and ask the coordinator for an interpreter matched to the patient's language variety.

Q03 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO A coworker privately tells a medical assistant, "When you interrupt my room report to ask about other patients, I sometimes lose my place and miss details." The assistant realizes they have been doing this and wants to respond constructively.

Which reply best demonstrates professional acceptance of the feedback?

A. "Thank you for pointing that out. I will let you finish the report before asking unrelated questions."

B. "I understand, but interruptions happen to everyone; we both need to become better at handling them."

C. "I was trying to save time. Please send your reports in writing so I can ask questions as needed."

D. "I appreciate your concern. Could you speak faster so I can raise the other issues before you leave?"

Q04 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO During a verified telephone call, a patient says, "I missed my follow-up because the bus route to your office ended. I still want to see the provider. Please ask the team to call me about what options I have." The medical assistant confirms the callback number and will relay the request to the clinical team.

Which message most accurately communicates the patient's report without adding a judgment or promise?

A. The patient is unlikely to attend future visits because the bus route ended; transportation arrangements are needed before further contact.

B. The patient needs a home visit because public transportation is unavailable; I reassured them that the provider could offer this service.

C. The patient reports missing follow-up because the bus route ended, still wants care, and requests a team callback about available options.

D. The patient has decided to postpone follow-up until transportation improves; I advised them to contact the clinic when ready to return.

Q05 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO A patient hands back an unfinished non-consent intake questionnaire and quietly says, "Reading these questions is difficult for me. I do not want everyone in the waiting room to hear." A private room is available, and the medical assistant may read the questions exactly as written and record the patient's own responses.

Which response best provides assistance while respecting the patient's dignity?

A. "You can skip the difficult questions; I will fill those in from what is already in your chart."

B. "Please ask a family member to finish it at home so you will not need to read it here."

C. "I will read the questions at the desk in a quieter voice so we can avoid delaying your visit."

D. "We can use a private room, and I can read each question while you tell me your responses."

Q06 | Patient-Centered Communication

SCENARIO While discussing products used at home, a patient says, "I drink a tea my family has prepared for generations. I did not mention it before because I thought people here would laugh." The assistant's role is to gather the patient's report and share it with the provider, not decide whether the product should be used.

Which response best encourages an accurate, culturally respectful conversation?

A. "Longstanding family remedies are usually fine; I can leave this out if you prefer."
B. "Thank you for telling me. What is in the tea, and how do you use it?"
C. "Please stop drinking it until we know more; then we can discuss why it matters to you."
D. "Please bring scientific evidence about the tea so the provider can decide whether to discuss it."

Q07 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO During virtual-visit setup, a patient with hearing loss relies on automatic captions. The patient reports that the captions repeatedly display unrelated words and says they cannot follow the questions. The video and audio connection itself is stable. Clinic policy calls for pausing intake, notifying the clinician, and arranging an effective approved communication aid. A real-time captioning service is available, and the patient requests it.

Which action best follows the policy and addresses the patient's communication need?

A. Pause intake, notify the clinician, and arrange the requested real-time captioning service.
B. Continue with automatic captions and ask the patient to guess unclear words from the surrounding sentence.
C. Turn off captions and speak louder because the connection's audio and video are stable.
D. Complete intake with brief questions and treat the patient's nods as confirmation that the captions are adequate.

Q08 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

SCENARIO A patient at checkout says in a raised voice, "I was sent to three different desks and nobody explained where to go." The patient is upset but has made no threat and is not blocking anyone. The medical assistant has not yet learned which service the patient needs. A quieter nearby area is available.

Which response best begins to address the complaint?

A. "I am sorry you are upset. Please return to the first desk so they can explain where you should go next."
B. "I can see this has been frustrating. I will promise you that the next desk will finish everything immediately."
C. "I understand that you are frustrated, but each desk has a different responsibility and our staff are very busy."
D. "That sounds frustrating. Let's step over here so I can listen and find out which service you need."

Q09 | Telephone Written and Virtual Communication

SCENARIO A medical assistant drafts a portal reply about an incomplete routine form: "You failed to answer the last two questions, so we cannot finish your request." The two answers are still needed. Clinic policy allows the patient to submit them through the portal or call the office for assistance.

Which revision best communicates the same next step in a neutral, helpful tone?

A. "Your form was not acceptable. Please correct it promptly so staff can continue reviewing the request you submitted."

B. "We still need the last two answers to process your request. Please send them through the portal or call us for help."

C. "We received your form and will process the request as submitted. Please contact us only if you later want to add information."

D. "The final questions are usually required, but please decide whether you want to answer them before the request is reviewed."

Q10 | Patient-Centered Communication

SCENARIO A patient becomes irritated when the medical assistant asks whether their medication list has changed. The patient says, "I answered this at my last appointment. Why does everyone keep asking me the same thing?" The clinic confirms changes at each visit so the care team has current information.

Which response best explains the reason while acknowledging the patient's experience?

A. "We ask everyone these questions, so please answer them again before we continue with anything else."

B. "You are right that repeating questions takes time; I can mark the list unchanged without asking this visit."

C. "I know it can feel repetitive. We check for changes each visit so your team has current information."

D. "Your previous answers must not have been recorded correctly, which is why I have to ask you again today."

Q11 | Accessible and Inclusive Communication

SCENARIO During a conversation, a medical assistant accidentally refers to a patient as "she." The patient quietly says, "I use they and them." The assistant knows the patient's name is Morgan and is about to continue asking why they came in today.

Which response best repairs the mistake while keeping the interaction centered on the patient?

A. "I am sorry. I will ask everyone nearby to hear the correction so we can discuss your pronouns together."

B. "Thank you for explaining. Could you tell me why those pronouns matter before we continue your intake today?"

C. "I'm sorry; they and them. Thank you, Morgan. What would you like the provider to know about today's concern?"

D. "Thank you, Morgan. I will explain the mistake to your companion and ask them which words I should use now."

Q12 | Teamwork Conflict and Professionalism

> **SCENARIO** Two medical assistants disagree about who should cover the reception desk during a planned break. They have checked the posted assignment, which is unclear, and tried to resolve the disagreement directly without success. Check-in coverage is about to be interrupted. Clinic policy directs unresolved coverage conflicts to the shift lead, who is available.

Which statement to the shift lead best supports a timely, professional resolution?

A. "We could not resolve the unclear break assignment, and check-in coverage is at risk. Can you clarify who should cover?"

B. "My coworker refuses to cooperate, so please tell them to cover reception while I take the break I expected today."

C. "We disagree about the break assignment, so we will both step away until someone decides whose interpretation is correct."

D. "The assignment is unclear, so I have told my coworker that my interpretation will apply for the rest of the shift."

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Practice Exam 20 | Domain 6: Communication and Customer Service | 12 scored questions

01 B	02 D	03 A	04 C	05 D	06 B
07 A	08 D	09 B	10 C	11 C	12 A

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: B

"What do you mean when you say you have been feeling funny?"

Asking the patient to explain their own wording obtains information without assigning a symptom or cause. The other questions introduce possibilities that the patient has not reported. Focused follow-up questions can be useful once the meaning of the initial statement is clearer.

Q02 | Correct answer: D

Pause the interview and ask the coordinator for an interpreter matched to the patient's language variety.

Both participants have identified that they cannot understand one another adequately. Following the stated policy means obtaining appropriately matched qualified language assistance before continuing substantive questions. Shorter sentences, unverified writing, or inferred meanings do not establish accurate two-way interpretation.

Q03 | Correct answer: A

"Thank you for pointing that out. I will let you finish the report before asking unrelated questions."

The reply accepts a specific observation and commits to a relevant change in behavior. It supports complete reports without shifting responsibility to the coworker. Explaining good intentions alone or asking the coworker to adapt does not address the interruption that caused the problem.

Q04 | Correct answer: C

The patient reports missing follow-up because the bus route ended, still wants care, and requests a team callback about available options.

The message retains the reported barrier, the patient's stated wish to continue care, and the requested callback. It attributes the reason to the patient without inventing refusal, postponement, or an approved service. The verified callback number should accompany the message so the team can respond.

Q05 | Correct answer: D

"We can use a private room, and I can read each question while you tell me your responses."

The offered help directly addresses both reading difficulty and the request for privacy. Reading the questions and recording the patient's responses preserves the patient's participation. Guessing from existing records or assuming a family member should complete the questionnaire can replace the patient's current account with someone else's assumptions.

Q06 | Correct answer: B

"Thank you for telling me. What is in the tea, and how do you use it?"

A respectful, nonjudgmental request for details makes it easier for the patient to provide an accurate account. The assistant can relay the reported ingredients and use to the provider without declaring the product safe or telling the patient to stop it independently. Respect for a tradition does not require assuming its clinical effects.

Q07 | Correct answer: A

Pause intake, notify the clinician, and arrange the requested real-time captioning service.

A stable connection does not make inaccurate captions an effective communication method. The patient's report and the supplied policy support arranging the available requested aid and informing the clinician. Guessing words or treating nods as proof of understanding leaves the identified barrier in place.

Q08 | Correct answer: D

"That sounds frustrating. Let's step over here so I can listen and find out which service you need."

The response acknowledges the frustration and begins gathering the information needed to resolve the navigation problem. Offering a quieter place supports a calmer exchange without assuming the patient is dangerous. Sending the patient to another desk, defending staff, or promising an immediate outcome does not establish what assistance is actually needed.

Q09 | Correct answer: B

"We still need the last two answers to process your request. Please send them through the portal or call us for help."

The revision identifies the missing information without blaming the patient and gives the two approved ways to respond. It preserves the actual requirement rather than suggesting the answers are optional or that processing is already proceeding. Neutral wording should improve the tone without changing the facts.

Q10 | Correct answer: C

"I know it can feel repetitive. We check for changes each visit so your team has current information."

The reply acknowledges repetition and explains its purpose using the clinic's stated reason. It avoids blaming other staff or inventing a documentation problem. Skipping the check and assuming no changes would defeat the purpose of obtaining current information.

Q11 | Correct answer: C

"I'm sorry; they and them. Thank you, Morgan. What would you like the provider to know about today's concern?"

A brief apology, use of the stated pronouns, and return to the patient's concern repair the error without making the patient manage the assistant's reaction. The patient's correction is sufficient for respectful address. Requiring an explanation, involving a companion, or drawing unnecessary public attention shifts the encounter away from the patient.

Q12 | Correct answer: A

"We could not resolve the unclear break assignment, and check-in coverage is at risk. Can you clarify who should cover?"

The statement gives the relevant facts, explains the effect on patient service, and asks the designated lead to clarify the assignment. It follows the supplied escalation route after a direct attempt has failed. Blame, unilateral authority, or withdrawing coverage makes the conflict harder to resolve and can disrupt check-in.

End of Practice Exam